Unit 2 Assignment: Sustainability Promotional Website

- Due No Due Date
- Points None

Unit 2: Sustainability Promotional Website (250 pts / 25%) (click this link for the Google Doc version) (https://docs.google.com/document/d/14LIVUZt5HVCp3J4Jc06Aam1-jcqVwzeF6-pfxaZwHCo/edit?usp=sharing)

Overview

In this unit, your group will create a **promotional website that addresses a sustainability issue at Georgia Tech.** Your project should communicate one (or more) of the **UN Sustainable Development Goals (https://sdgs.un.org/goals)** and **Georgia Tech's Strategic Plan: Sustainability Next (https://sustain.gatech.edu/sustainability-next-plan/)** .

The goal of this project is to provide information and raise awareness about sustainability issue and initiative of your choice. But it should also go beyond that by leading this raised awareness to specific actions, which makes persuasion an important part of this work on top of the promotion part.

Also, you will practice communicating **as an organizational author**: making communication and design decisions that align with the identity, values, and goals of the organizatino of your choice (or Georgia Tech more broadly) while responding to the needs and interests of a specific audience.

Your website should introduce a sustainability issue, explain why it matters, and introduce an initiative, program, organization, or resource that you would like your audience to learn about and engage with. You should also develop creative and meaningful ways of encouraging your audience to take action.

Throughout the project, think carefully about the relationship between **Institutional Alignment + Target Audience + Communicative Purpose**

Your website should demonstrate that you can communicate not only about an issue but also **for an organization and to a particular audience.**

Your Task

Create a fully developed promotional website focused on **one sustainability issue relevant to the Georgia Tech community**.

Your website should:

- identify and explain a sustainability issue;
- connect the issue to relevant **UN Sustainable Development Goal(s)** and **Georgia Tech's Sustainability Next Plan**;
- provide sufficient background and evidence for your audience to understand the issue;
- identify a specific **target audience** and make communication/design decisions based on that audience;
- introduce one or more existing initiatives, programs, organizations, or resources that address the issue;
- explain why these initiatives are relevant to your audience;
- develop meaningful ways for your audience to become involved or take action; and
- communicate as an organizational author, with attention to the identity, values, and priorities of the organization/initiative/program that you're representing.

Your website should contain approximately **1,200–2,000 words** of written content. Some of these written content can be communicated through electronic and/or oral communication such as video recording and/or podcast as well as through visual communication such as data visualization, (interactive) map, graphs, pie charts, etc.

Multimodal & Interactive Communication

A central goal of this project is to **experiment with different ways of communicating with an audience**. Your website must therefore include:

- **At least one video**
  - Include at least one embedded video that contributes meaningfully to your communication. The video may be created by your group or come from another appropriate source.
- **At least one interactive feature**
  - Include at least one interactive element that allows your audience to explore, respond to, or engage with information.

You might use a quiz, interactive map, poll, timeline, data visualization, clickable elements, or something else—but **you are not limited to these examples**.

The purpose of these requirements is not simply to check off two items. Use this project as an opportunity to explore what different modes can do that written text alone cannot.

You should also consider how other visual and multimodal elements—such as images, graphics, data, typography, color, audio, hyperlinks, or animation—can contribute to your communication.

Final Website Requirements

Your final website should include:

- One clearly defined sustainability issue relevant to Georgia Tech.
- A meaningful connection to one or more UN SDGs.
- A meaningful connection to Georgia Tech's Sustainability Next Plan.
- A clearly identified target audience.
- Background information and credible evidence.
- An introduction to one or more relevant initiatives, programs, organizations, or resources.
- Meaningful opportunities or calls to action for your audience.
- Approximately 1,200–2,000 words of written content.
- At least **one embedded video**.
- At least **one interactive feature**.
- Effective use of multimodal communication.
- A clear, coherent, and audience-appropriate web design.
- Appropriate sources and hyperlinks.
- Evidence of organizational authorship and institutional alignment.

Key Dates

- **Research Report:** Oct. 9, Friday *(with a two-day grace period)*
- **First Draft:** Oct. 16, Friday *(with a two-day grace period)*
- **Final Website:** Oct. 23, Friday *(with a two-day grace period)*

Evaluation Criteria

1. Audience & Rhetorical Purpose

Does the website demonstrate a clear understanding of its target audience and communicative purpose? Are the language, tone, organization, and design appropriate for that audience?

2. Organizational Authorship & Institutional Alignment

Does the website communicate effectively as an organizational author? Does it meaningfully connect the issue to Georgia Tech's identity, priorities, and sustainability goals?

3. Content & Evidence

Does the website clearly explain the sustainability issue, provide relevant background and evidence, and introduce the initiative(s) being promoted?

4. Persuasiveness & Engagement

Does the website give the audience a reason to care? Does it provide meaningful and specific opportunities for the audience to engage or take action?

5. Multimodal & Interactive Communication

Do the written, visual, video, and interactive elements work together effectively? Are multimedia and interactive features used purposefully rather than simply decoratively?

6. Design & Usability

Is the website organized, readable, visually coherent, and easy for the intended audience to navigate?

7. Collaboration & Revision

Does the final website demonstrate thoughtful collaboration, experimentation, revision, and attention to detail?

Resources

- **Sample 1: Belong Here and Lead Everywhere [Gender Equity] (https://canva.link/xnm1hbtz4sq6env)**
- **Sample 2: Shaping AI Guidelines at GT (https://krishasknani.github.io/ai-at_gt-lmc3403.github.io/)**
- **Sample 3: Office of Sustainability (https://sustain.gatech.edu/)**
- **Sample 4: Ocean Central by Wave (https://oceancentral.org/)**
- **Sample 5: Ocean Now (https://ocean-now.org/)**

These examples are provided as opportunities to examine how other communicators organize information, address audiences, use multimodal communication, and encourage engagement. **You do not need to follow their structure or design.** Use them as starting points for thinking about the possibilities of web-based communication.